AI × SECURITY

AI agents just found 2 new cracks in RSA-1024

Google DeepMind · 6 Nov 2026
What it means for your stack

Swipe →

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WHAT HAPPENED

Weeks, not years

- AI agents, guided by human cryptanalysts, found two weaknesses in legacy 1024-bit RSA.
- Published as two working papers on 5 and 6 November.
- The work took weeks, per DeepMind.

CRACK #1

Signature forgery

- If an attacker controls about half or more of the signed block, the padding stops protecting it.
- Theoretical estimate: **~1,600×** better than the previous best forgery method.
- A known attack was reproduced with **3.5× less** CPU time.

CRACK #2

Batch factoring

- A new “fan factory” algorithm for factoring many keys at once.
- Each extra 1024-bit key costs about **30× less** than with earlier batch methods.
- Attacking old keys in bulk just got cheaper.

DON'T PANIC

Your modern keys are fine

- RSA-2048 and larger: **not affected**.
- No 1024-bit key was factored from scratch.
- The risk sits in legacy systems nobody has looked at in years.

WHERE IT HIDES

RSA-1024 is still out there

- Old SSH keys on servers and CI
- Legacy VPNs and firewalls
- Embedded firmware and IoT devices
- Old certificates and token-signing keys

YOUR 10-MINUTE AUDIT

Check key sizes

```
# SSH key (first number = bits)
ssh-keygen -lf ~/.ssh/id_rsa.pub

# Certificate
openssl x509 -in cert.pem -noout \
  -text | grep Public-Key

# Private key
openssl rsa -in key.pem -noout \
  -text | head -1
```

Found 1024? Move to Ed25519/ECDSA or RSA ≥ 3072.

MY TAKE

Crypto “hardness” now has an expiry date

AI is compressing years of cryptanalysis into weeks. Audit your legacy keys before someone else does.

SOURCES

Google DeepMind announcement, 6 Nov 2026

Crypto Briefing — cryptobriefing.com

WebProNews — webpronews.com

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